

BSc (Hons) in **Computer Science****SE3062 : Intelligent Systems**

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026

Faculty of Computing**Practical 07**

Module Objective: In previous weeks, your Drow Ranger agent used A* Search to find a physical path to the goal. However, it blindly assumed every non-wall tile was safe. Today, we implement a **Knowledge Base (KB)** and a **Forward Chaining Inference Engine**. Your agent must now mathematically prove a cell is logically *Feasible* before taking a step, using real-time rules about map vision and enemy threats.

Before you start: This lab continues the project from Labs 1–4. Open the same project and check that `SearchAgent.astar_search()` in `agent.py` works.

- Parts 1, 2 & 4: new files (`logic_engine.py` , `test_logic.py`) in the project folder.
- Part 3: edit your existing `agent.py` .
- **Create a separate branch `lab-07`** and start your work there. When finished, **commit your code and push the branch**, as you did in Labs 1–4.
- **Upload this worksheet's answered PDF to the submission portal.**

Part 1: The Logic Engine Architecture

Step 1.1: Building the Knowledge Base (KB)

Instead of hardcoding hundreds of nested `if-else` statements in our agent's movement logic, we will build a declarative Knowledge Base. You need to design a Python class that stores **Facts** (current percepts) and **Rules** (Horn Clauses).

1. Create a new file named `logic_engine.py` .
2. Implement a `KnowledgeBase` class based on the following structural requirements:

```
CLASS KnowledgeBase:  
    // Attributes
```

```

DECLARE facts AS Set           // To store unique string fact
DECLARE rules AS List          // To store rules as Tuples: (

// Methods
FUNCTION tell_fact(fact_string):
    ADD fact_string TO facts

FUNCTION tell_rule(premise_list, conclusion_string):
    APPEND Tuple(premise_list, conclusion_string) TO rules

FUNCTION clear_facts():
    EMPTY the facts Set

```

Part 2: Implementing Forward Chaining

Step 2.1: The Inference Algorithm

The agent needs an Inference Engine to deduce new information from its raw sensors. Translate the following Data-Driven **Forward Chaining** algorithm into a Python method inside your `KnowledgeBase` class.

1. Write the `forward_chain()` method.
2. Ensure you use a `while` loop that continues to iterate over the rules until a full pass results in absolutely no new facts being deduced.

```

FUNCTION forward_chain():
    DECLARE new_facts_added = TRUE

    WHILE new_facts_added == TRUE:
        new_facts_added = FALSE

        FOR EACH (premises, conclusion) IN rules:
            IF conclusion IS NOT IN facts:

                // Modus Ponens Check
                IF ALL premises ARE IN facts:

```

```
ADD conclusion TO facts
new_facts_added = TRUE
```

Part 3: Hooking Logic into the Grid Game

Step 3.1: Defining the Game Constraints

Now we translate the game's safety constraints into our logic engine using Propositional Logic.

1. In `agent.py`, add `from logic_engine import KnowledgeBase`, then create the KB in `SearchAgent.__init__`: `self.kb = KnowledgeBase()`.
2. Use your `tell_rule` method to define the following safety rules:
Rule 1: `TargetVisible  $\wedge$  HasDust  $\Rightarrow$  SafeToEngage`
Rule 2: `SafeToEngage  $\wedge$  BloodseekerMissing  $\Rightarrow$  Retreat`

The game does not produce these facts, so you supply them per tile as a dictionary: `{(x, y): [facts]}`. A tile where `Retreat` is deduced is unsafe to enter.

Step 3.2: Validating Feasibility in A*

Modify your existing A* pathfinding algorithm to consult the Knowledge Base before expanding a node.

1. Add a parameter `tile_facts=None` to `astar_search()` (treat `None` as `{}`).
2. Locate the neighbor-generation loop in your A* code (where you normally check for physical walls).
3. Before adding a neighbor to the `open_list`, clear the KB facts.
4. Feed that tile's facts into the KB: `for fact in tile_facts.get(successor, []): self.kb.tell_fact(fact)`.
5. Run `self.kb.forward_chain()`.
6. If `'Retreat'` is deduced and exists in `self.kb.facts`, mark the tile as **Infeasible**. Skip it (do not add it to the open list), even if it is physically reachable.

Step 3.3: Run It in the Grid

1. In `sense_and_act()` , define sample facts and pass them to A*:

```
tile facts = {
    (1, 0): ['TargetVisible', 'HasDust', 'BloodseekerMissing'], # dedu
    (0, 1): ['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'], # Safe
}
self.plan = self.astar_search(position, nearest_food, walls, grid_size,
```

2. Run `visual_grid_game.py` . The agent should never step onto `(1, 0)` .

Part 4: Self-Evaluation Test Cases

4.1 Automated Validation

Create a file named `test_logic.py` . Copy and run the following Python assert statements to verify your Forward Chaining engine works correctly mathematically before you attempt to integrate it into the visual grid.

```
from logic_engine import KnowledgeBase

def test_forward_chaining():
    kb = KnowledgeBase()

    # Add Domain Rules
    kb.tell_rule(['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'], 'SafeToEngage')
    kb.tell_rule(['SafeToEngage', 'BloodseekerMissing'], 'Retreat')

    # Test Case 1: Safe Engagement
    kb.clear_facts()
    kb.tell_fact('TargetVisible')
    kb.tell_fact('HasDust')
    kb.forward_chain()
    assert 'SafeToEngage' in kb.facts, "Test 1 Failed: Should deduce Sa
    assert 'Retreat' not in kb.facts, "Test 1 Failed: Should NOT deduce

    # Test Case 2: Unsafe Engagement (Bloodseeker Missing)
    kb.clear_facts()
```

```

kb.tell_fact('TargetVisible')
kb.tell_fact('HasDust')
kb.tell_fact('BloodseekerMissing')
kb.forward_chain()
assert 'Retreat' in kb.facts, "Test 2 Failed: Should deduce Retreat

print("✅ All Logic Engine Test Cases Passed!")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    test_forward_chaining()

```

Part 5: Theory-to-Implementation Mapping

Based on the code you just wrote and the lecture on Logical Reasoning, complete the following analytical questions to explain *how* your code implements the theory.

1. Reachability vs. Feasibility (Apply)

In Step 3.2, you modified the A* algorithm's neighbor-generation loop. How does your new code differentiate between checking if a node is "Reachable" (like a wall collision) versus checking if it is "Feasible"? Explain how the Knowledge Base enforces feasibility.

Reachability (Physical Check): Differentiates whether a node can be physically traversed based on spatial boundaries ($0 \leq \text{new_pos}[0] < \text{grid_size}[0]$) and physical obstacles (new_pos not in walls).

Feasibility (Logical Check): Differentiates whether a physically reachable node is safe to enter based on domain constraints.

KB Enforcement: Before pushing a neighbor to open_list, astar_search() clears the Knowledge Base, loads the tile's percept facts, and triggers self.kb.forward_chain(). If the logical inference derives 'Retreat', the tile is deemed infeasible and skipped (pruned from search).

2. Declarative vs. Procedural Paradigms (Analyze)

Why did we build a KnowledgeBase class with a forward_chain() loop instead of simply writing if 'TargetVisible' in percepts and 'HasDust' in

percepts: directly inside the agent's movement code? What happens to the agent's code complexity if we add 50 new game rules?

Declarative Paradigm: Decouples domain knowledge (facts and Horn clause rules) from the inference engine (`forward_chain()`). The movement code only queries the Knowledge Base rather than managing state transitions.

Procedural Approach Drawback: Direct if-else checks tightly couple decision-making with movement logic, forcing the agent to hardcode all multi-step inference paths manually.

Impact of Adding 50 Rules:

1.Procedural: Code complexity explodes exponentially with deeply nested, unmaintainable if-else structures.

2.Declarative: Search and movement logic complexity remains unchanged ($O(1)$ code modification). Adding 50 rules simply requires 50 additional `kb.tell_rule()` statements, which `forward_chain()` processes automatically without modifying pathfinding code.

3. Modus Ponens & Horn Clauses (Understand)

The rule `['TargetVisible', 'HasDust']  $\Rightarrow$  'SafeToEngage'` is formally known as a Horn Clause. Briefly explain how your Python implementation of the `forward_chain()` `while` loop acts as a mathematical execution of the *Modus Ponens* inference rule.

Modus Ponens Rule: States that if premise **P** is true and implication **P $\Rightarrow$ Q** is true, then conclusion Q is deduced as true.

Horn Clause: A rule of the form **P₁ $\wedge$ P₂ $\wedge$... $\wedge$ P_n $\Rightarrow$ Q**, represented in code as `(['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'], 'SafeToEngage')`.

Execution in Code: The `while new_facts_added:` loop iteratively evaluates rule tuples (premises, conclusion). The condition `all (p in self.facts for p in premises)` mathematically checks if all conjunct premises **P_i** are currently proven. When satisfied, `self.facts.add(conclusion)` asserts **Q** into the true fact set, repeating until fixed-point logical closure is reached.

Finalize and Lock Lab 07 Implementation



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